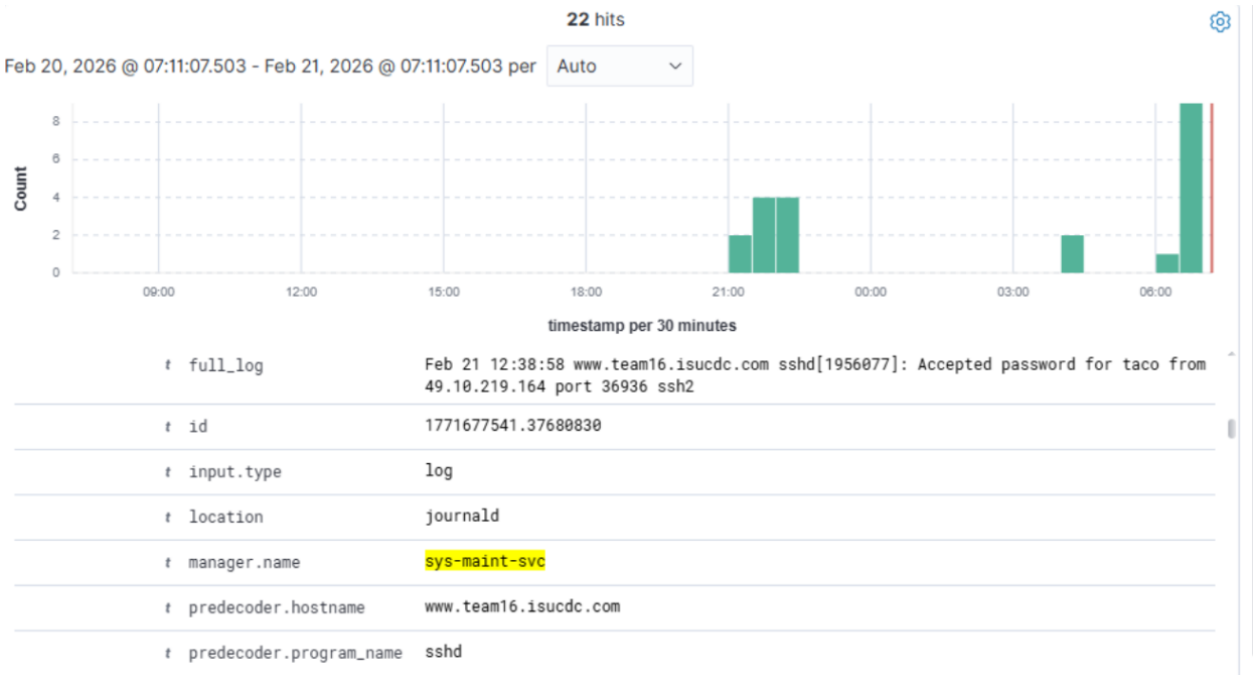
Cacttus Shield – Intrusion Report

Team 16

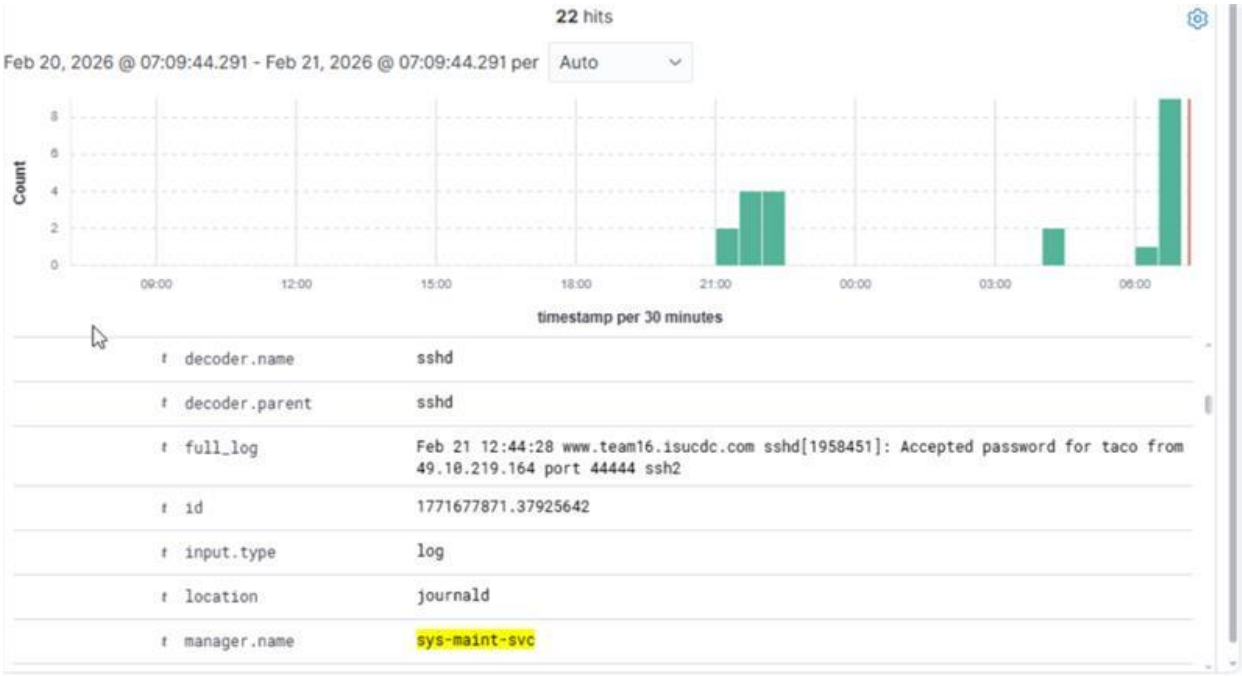
Cacttus Education

IDS/Monitoring Overview

Our team used Wazuh/OSSEC with a Kibana dashboard (sys-maint-svc) to monitor security events across all servers. The IDS was configured to detect brute force attempts, unauthorized logins, and other suspicious activity. The following report covers detected incidents during the competition period.

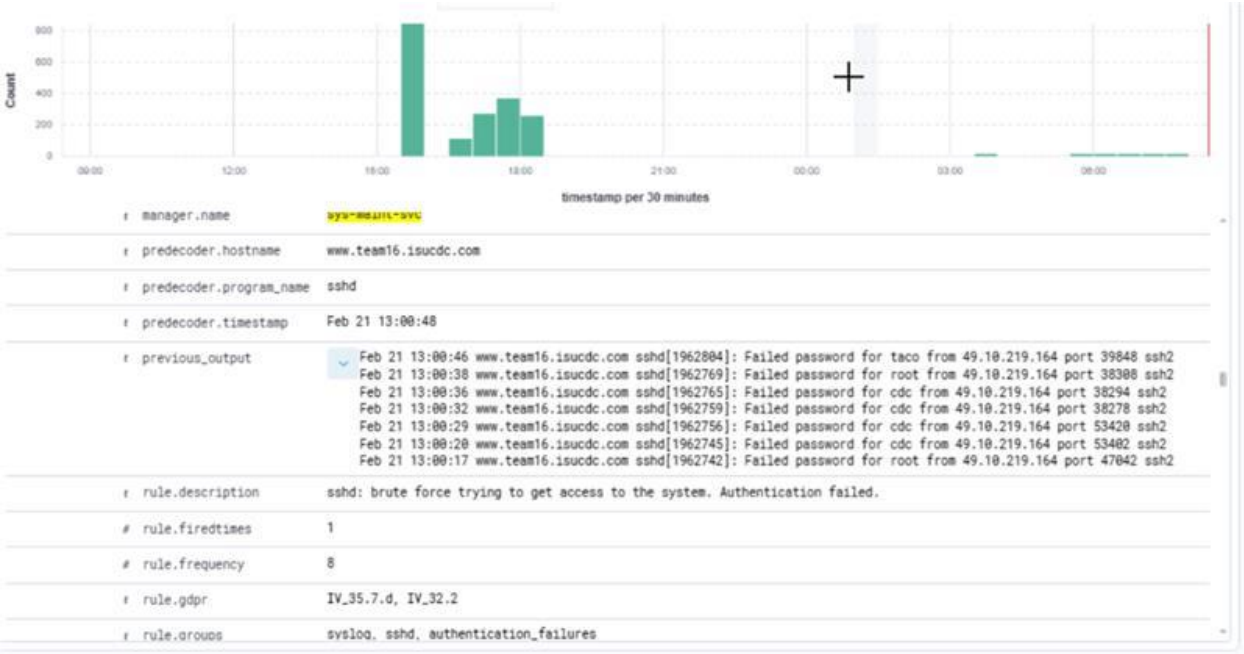


Successful SSH Login via Backdoor Account



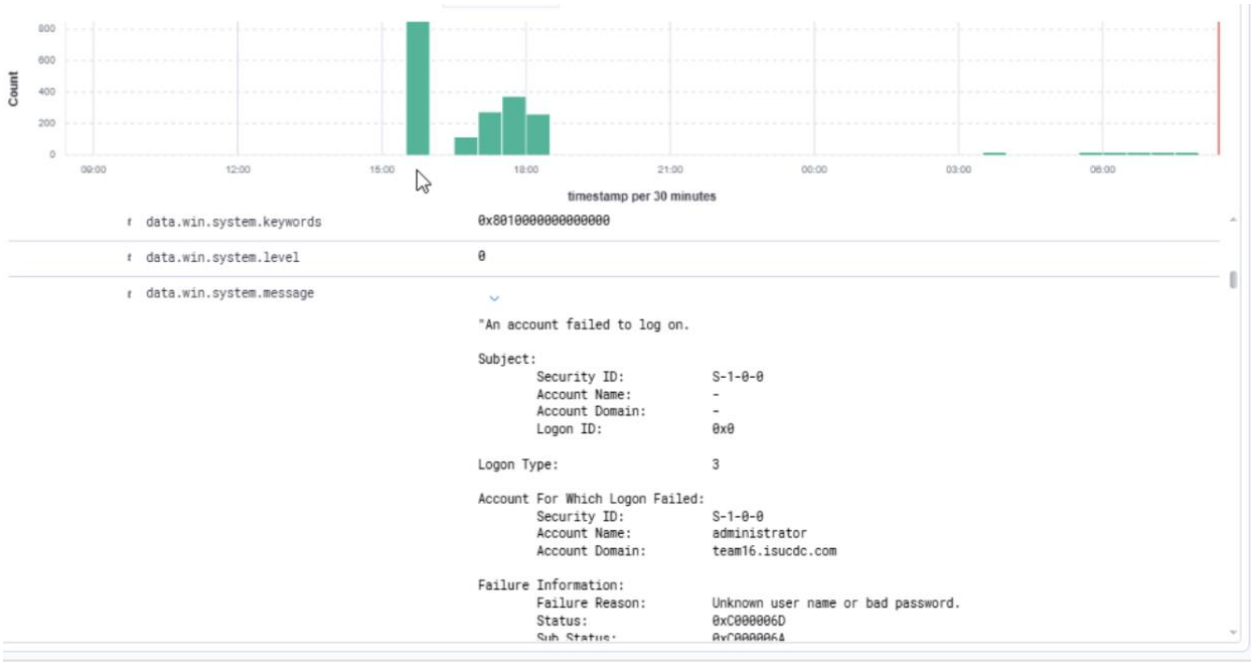
Between 12:38PM and 12:44 PM we detected a multiple successful SSH login on the WWW server from IP 49.10.219.164 using the account “taco”.Upon investigation, we determined that "taco" was a backdoor account that was pre-planted on the system in the initial configuration provided to us.We changed the password for the account to prevent further unauthorized access.

Brute force SSH Attack



At approximately 1:00 PM on February 21st, our IDS detected a brute force SSH attack against the WWW server. The attacker from IP 49.10.219.164 attempted to log in using multiple usernames including "root", "cdc", and "taco". The IDS rule triggered after 8 failed attempts, flagging the activity as "sshd: brute force trying to get access to the system. Authentication failed." All attempts in this sequence failed.

AD/Domain Controller (team16.isucdc.com)



At approximately 3:00 PM on February 20th, we detected a high volume of failed login attempts on our Active Directory domain controller (team16.isucdc.com).The logs show someone repeatedly trying to log in as "administrator" with wrong passwords. Over 600 attempts in 30 minutes means this was automated.This is a brute force attack targeting the domain admin account the attack failed. All attempts were rejected. The attacker did not gain access to the administrator account.

Cynet Security Alert

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[cdc@mgmt tmp]$ ls
crontab.RiGGN1                          systemd-private-aa0c70b5af4e446db07c0417582503da-chronyd.service-B6SIPh  wazuh-agent-4.9.0-1.x86_64.rpm
dkms_rpm_safe_upgrade_lock.3970804.nkekz9  systemd-private-aa0c70b5af4e446db07c0417582503da-mariadb.service-HXMaqg  wazuh-agent-4.9.2-1.x86_64.rpm
svc.cynet                               wazuh-agent-4.14.3-1.x86_64.rpm
```

At 2:21 PM on February 21st, our antivirus (Cynet) detected a trojan on the MGMT server. A malicious file called /tmp/svc tried to run. The malware was identified as TR/LINUX.Sliver.G, which is a tool that gives attackers remote control of a machine.The file was launched through the backend Flask application running under the "cdc" user, meaning the attacker likely used a vulnerability in the backend app to place and run the malware.Our antivirus automatically killed the process and quarantined the file. The attack was blocked successfully.